MASTER FUNCTIONAL SKILLS • REGULATORY GOVERNANCE (MFS-GOV-03)

Malpractice, Maladministration & AI Integrity Policy

Protecting the national credibility of Functional Skills certificates through robust exam security, staff governance, and generative AI controls.

Document Reference	MFS-GOV-03	**Effective Date**	11 November 2026
Quality & Centre Lead	Abdul (Head of Centre)	**Regulatory Alignment**	Ofqual Condition A8 & JCQ AI Use in Assessments Guidance

1. Definitions: Candidate Malpractice, Staff Maladministration & AI Misuse

Master Functional Skills enforces zero tolerance toward any act that compromises the authenticity, security, or integrity of regulated Functional Skills assessments:

- **Candidate Malpractice:** Any deliberate or negligent breach of exam rules — including impersonation, possession of unauthorised mobile/smart devices, dual-monitor or HDMI mirroring, third-party room presence, unauthorised notes, or use of calculators in Non-Calculator Paper Section A.
- **Generative AI Misuse:** Using ChatGPT, browser AI sidebars, grammar-rewriting plugins, automated translation, voice-to-answer assistants, or AI-generated scripts delivered verbatim during English Writing, Reading, Digital Skills, or SLC controlled assessments.
- **Centre Maladministration / Staff Malpractice:** Any failure by staff to follow Awarding Organisation invigilation, secure paper storage, IQA sampling, or registration rules, or offering improper assistance during live assessments.

2. Preventive Controls Across Remote & Controlled Assessments

Master Functional Skills prevents malpractice proactively before and during every assessment sitting:

Risk Area	Preventive Technical & Procedural Control	Monitoring & Audit Mechanism
Generative AI & Browser Extensions	Secure lockdown / XAMS browser environment; all AI extensions, Grammarly Pro rewriters, and secondary apps closed via Task Manager check	Pre-exam Task Manager inspection + live screen stream recording
Second Person / Off-Camera Coaching	Mandatory 360-degree webcam/smartphone room & under-desk sweep; closed doors; ears visible (no earbuds/headphones unless	Continuous audio/video invigilation + secondary mobile side-angle camera where required

	approved)	
Section A Non-Calculator Breach	Physical desk inspection verifying only blank scratch paper and pen; onscreen calculator disabled in Section A	Invigilator desk check before & after Section A (paper torn up on camera at end)
SLC Scripted AI Reading	Candidates permitted brief bullet-point cue cards only (checked on camera), never full word-for-word paragraphs; spontaneous Q&A tested live	Assessor cue-card check + recorded spontaneous peer Q&A verification

3. Investigation, Reporting to Awarding Organisation & Sanctions

Suspected malpractice or maladministration identified via live invigilation, XAMS proctoring flags, video review, or IQA audit triggers immediate containment:

- **Immediate Notification (Within 24–48 Hours):** The Quality Nominee (Abdul) secures all webcam recordings, keystroke/browser logs, and invigilator incident reports and notifies Open Awards (or the relevant Awarding Organisation) promptly in accordance with Condition A8.
- **Right to Respond:** Accused candidates or staff are informed in writing of the allegation and invited to submit a written statement within 5 working days.
- **Proportional Sanctions:** Awarding Organisations hold sole authority over qualification sanctions, ranging from formal warning and component mark disqualification to full series/qualification debarment.

Document Control & Annual Governance Sign-Off

Approved By (Head of Centre & Quality Nominee):	Abdul — Master Functional Skills
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